جامعة الشارقة
UNIVERSITY OF SHARJAH

Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies Office

College of Graduate Studies

Master's Executive Regulations

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Objective

To familiarize graduate students with the university bylaws and regulations governing their graduate studies from admission to graduation.

Study Duration for a Master's Degree:

a) Full-time students: A minimum of three semesters and a maximum of eight semesters, excluding allowed postponement periods.
b) Part-time students: A minimum of six semesters and a maximum of ten semesters, excluding allowed postponement periods.

- Students who used their maximum study duration must submit an Extension for Thesis Defense Purposes form immediately after their final semester through E-services. The extension is for no more than two additional semesters. It begins immediately upon completion of the maximum study duration. Students who interrupt their studies after the maximum study duration ends are not permitted to request an extension.

- In this case, the student is responsible for paying the prescribed fees according to university regulations.

Study Duration for a Master's Degree:

- The study load per semester is **9-12** credit hours for full-time students and less than 9 (1-8 credit hours) for part-time students. Full-time students may take fewer than 9 credit hours under special circumstances related to the student or the program, subject to the Dean's approval.

Admission Conditions and Selection Criteria

1. Students must hold a bachelor's degree with a minimum grade of Good and a CGPA of no less than 3.0 out of 4.0 or its equivalent.

2. Students with CGPAs between 2.5 and 2.99 may be admitted on a conditional basis, provided that they register for 6 credit hours (master's level) in their first semester and achieve a GPA of 3.0. If this condition is not met, the student may register for 3 credit hours in the second semester (choosing from available courses not previously taken). The student will be dismissed from the program if they fail to achieve a GPA of 3.0 by the end of the second semester.

Q: What happens if a student registers for two courses in the first semester and receives a C+ grade in both courses?

Admission Conditions and Selection Criteria

3. Students must meet the English language proficiency requirement.

4. Students are not permitted to simultaneously enroll in two master's programs at the university.

5. Students must achieve a minimum grade of C+ to pass each master's program course. Remedial courses require a minimum grade of C and are recorded on a Pass/Fail basis only.

Q: What happens if a student registered for one course in the first semester and their grade was 74%?

English Language Proficiency Requirement

1. **Programs taught in English:**

✓ Students must achieve a minimum score of 550 on the TOEFL, 6 on the IELTS, or 1400 on the EMSAT.

2. **Programs taught in Arabic that are exempt from the language requirement:**

✓ Programs that do not require English language proficiency are Master's in Arabic Language, History, and Sharia.

3. **Programs with specific TOEFL requirements as mandated by academic accreditation entities:**

- Applied Sociology: TOEFL 450, IELTS 4.5, or completion of ESL studies
- Law: TOEFL 450, IELTS 4.5, or completion of ESL studies

English Language Proficiency Requirement

Exemptions

1. Native English speakers are exempt from the TOEFL requirement if they completed their bachelor's degree in English in a country where English is the official language.

2. Students who graduated from academic institutions that use English as the language of instruction are exempt from the English language requirement if they achieved a score of 1400 on the EMSAT or 500 on the TOEFL (ITP), or equivalent, when registering for their bachelor's degree studies.

English Language Proficiency Requirement

Table of Equivalent Scores on Tests of English Language Proficiency		
EmSAT	**Paper-Based TOEFL ITP***	**ILETS academic**
950-1075	450	4.5
1100-1225	500	5.0
1250-1375	530	5.5
1400-1525	550	6.0

* The exam is offered only by the University of Sharjah, AMIDEAST Dubai, and the Abu Dhabi head offices.

Program Transfer within the university

Master students may transfer from one program to another within the university after completing at least one semester, subject to approval from both relevant departments and following standard admission procedures, with the following conditions:

- The student must meet the admission requirements for the target program, including GPA requirements, availability of seats, and any other specified conditions.
- The Graduate Studies Committee in the department may recommend to the Dean that a maximum of 12 credit hours of equivalent courses previously completed at the university be transferred, provided that these credits are included in the student's new cumulative GPA.
- The student has not had their registration cancelled or been dismissed from the university.
- One semester is deducted from the maximum allowed study duration for every 6-9 transferred credit hours from the previous program.

Postponement

- Master students may request a postponement during the first half of the semester, before exceeding the maximum study duration.
- The postponement period shall not exceed three consecutive or separate semesters for full-time students and four semesters for part-time students, subject to approval by the Dean based on a recommendation from the Graduate Studies Committee in the department.
- A student's studies are automatically postponed if the student is withdrawn from all courses for exceeding the permitted absence rate with an excuse approved by the Dean. This period counts toward the total postponement period.

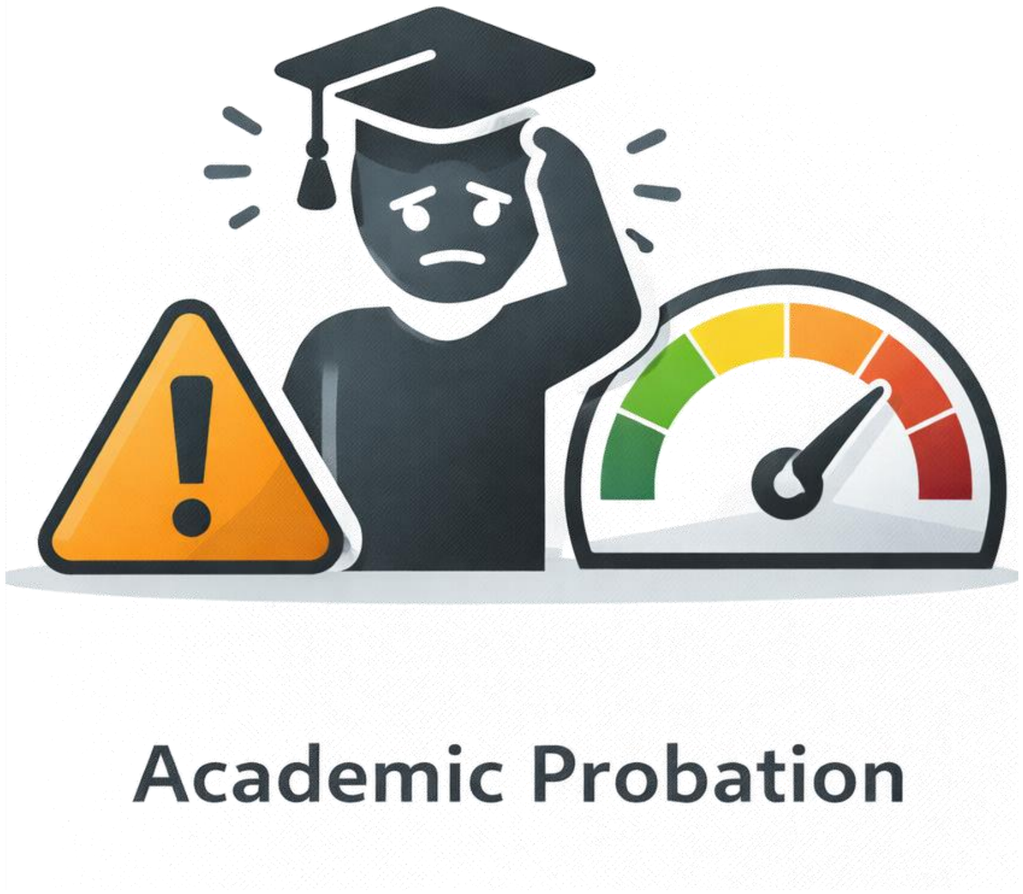
Q: In which cases is a student required to apply for study postponement?

Withdrawal

- Students are permitted to withdraw from one or more courses during the **first week** of the semester without the course(s) being recorded on their transcript. Students may withdraw from one or more courses from the **second week through the tenth week** of the semester. The symbol "W" (Withdrawn) will be recorded on their academic transcript.
- The Dean may approve a student's withdrawal from courses provided that at least 3 credit hours remain, if the student presents convincing justifications accepted by the Dean and within the specified timeframe.
- The Dean may approve a student's withdrawal from all registered courses at least two weeks before final examinations begin, upon submission of convincing justifications.
- The Dean may approve a student's withdrawal from the program before final examinations begin.
- Students with a CGPA below 3.0 out of 4.0 are not permitted re-admission to the same program.
- If a student is absent for two consecutive or separate semesters, they are considered withdrawn from the program and may only return to study with Council approval. **(Q: Can the student apply for postponement to avoid being considered withdrawn?)**

Q: What does compulsory withdrawal from the program mean?

Master's Executive Regulations



The Deanship places students on academic probation in the following cases:

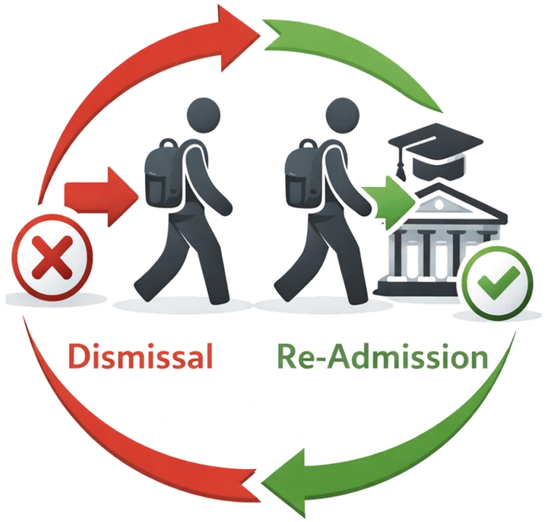
a. If the student fails to achieve a CGPA of 3.0 out of 4.0 at the end of any semester.

b. If the supervisor (and co-supervisor if present) determines that the student has neglected their master's thesis.

Students whose CGPA falls below 3.0 will be placed on academic probation and will be dismissed from the program after three consecutive or separate probations.

Q: What does 'neglecting the master's thesis' mean?

Dismissal and Re-Admission



- A student shall be dismissed from the program by decision of the Dean and is not permitted to return to the same program in the following cases:
  1. If the student fails any course twice.
  2. If the student fails three courses from their study plan throughout their enrollment in the program.
  3. If the student fails the comprehensive examination twice.
  4. If the student commits a violation punishable by dismissal in accordance with the university bylaws and regulations.
  5. If the student receives "No Pass" twice in their master's thesis defense.
  6. If the student fails any remedial course.
  7. If the student fails to achieve the minimum CGPA of 3.0 out of 4.0 upon receiving the third probation.
  8. If a conditionally admitted student (condition B) fails to achieve a GPA of 3.0 out of 4.0 after completing 9 credit hours.

Dismissal and Re-Admission

- A student who withdraws from all courses in their first semester of study may be readmitted to the program with approval from the Graduate Studies Council.

- Students dismissed from the university (not just the program) for violating university bylaws, regulations, and policies are not permitted re-admission.

- Students dismissed from the program due to low CGPA may be permitted, with the Dean's approval, to study up to 9 credit hours as a "special study student" for the purpose of raising their cumulative GPA. They will be re-admitted to their original program upon raising their GPA to 3.0, subject to the following conditions:

  a)Their GPA at the time of dismissal must not be less than 2.5 out of 4.0.

  b)Students are permitted to continue in special study status for a period not exceeding two semesters, which does not count toward the maximum allowed study duration for graduation.

Dismissal and Re-Admission

- Students whose registration was cancelled due to interruption or withdrawal from the program may apply for re- admission if they meet the admission requirements for their previous major and receive a recommendation from the academic department. Re- admission follows the same standard admission procedures.

Study Interruption

- If a student interrupts their studies for one semester (does not register for any credit hours and does not submit a postponement request), the student will be withdrawn from the program.

- If the student returns to the program after one semester of interruption, they will be automatically re-admitted, and the interruption semester will be deducted from their allowed postponement period.

- If the student has already used all their postponement period, the interruption semester will be deducted from the maximum study duration in the program.

Study Interruption

- If a student interrupts their studies for **two separate or consecutive semesters,** they will be subject to compulsory withdrawal (dismissal) from the program. If the student wishes to resume their study in the program, they must submit a new admission application, which will be considered alongside the applications of new applicants. The standard admission requirements and procedures shall apply.

- If the student is accepted into the program, the following rule applies:

  a. If the period of study interruption is three (3) years or less, the student may submit a request to the academic department for recognition/equivalency of the courses previously completed, provided that their CGPA was at least 3 out of 4 at the time of withdrawal.

  b. If the period of study interruption exceeds three (3) years, the courses previously completed will not be recognized or considered equivalent.

Examinations and Grades

Mark (100%)	Letter Grade	Points
90 to 100	A	4
85 to less than 90	B+	3.5
80 to less than 85	B	3
75 to less than 80	C+	2.5
70 to less than 75	C	2
Less than 70	F	0

Points	Grades
From 3.70 - 4.00	Excellent
From 3.00 - 3.69	Very Good
From 2.50 - 2.99	Good (Does not meet graduation condition)
Less than 2.50	Fail

Q: What is the difference between a grade of 55% and 72%

Examinations and Grades

- The passing grade for each master's program course is C+. For remedial courses, the passing grade is C, and results are recorded as Pass or Fail only.
- The minimum cumulative GPA required for graduation is 3.0 out of 4.0.
- Students may retake a maximum of three courses for the purpose of raising their GPA throughout their study duration. The higher grade will be calculated in the student's cumulative GPA.
- In the case of failing an elective course, students may take an alternative elective course to replace the failed course. Grades for elective courses exceeding the study plan requirements are not included in the CGPA but remain recorded on the transcript.

Examinations and Grades

- If a student is absent from the final exam or coursework due to a medical or compelling excuse accepted by the Dean, a grade of "Incomplete" (I) will be recorded.
- The student must complete this grade by the end of the first week of the following semester in which they register. Otherwise, the Registration Department will convert the final exam grade or missing grades to zero, and the grade obtained will be recorded on the student's transcript.

Q: What is the deadline to request an Incomplete grade?

- If a student's absences in a course requiring attendance exceed 25% of the total designated hours, and the absence is **without an excuse** accepted by the instructor and approved by the Dean, the student will be barred from taking the final examination and will receive a grade of (F).
- The student may withdraw from the course if the withdrawal period is still in effect according to these regulations.

- If a student's absences in a course requiring attendance exceed 25% of the total designated hours, and the absence is **due to a medical or compelling excuse** within university guidelines, the student is considered withdrawn and the symbol "W" (Withdrawn) will be recorded on their transcript.

Thesis Proposal Registration

- Students may register their thesis proposal after meeting the following requirements:
  - Students may register their thesis in the second semester of enrollment in the program (excluding remedial course semesters), provided that their GPA is not less than 3.0, they have completed all remedial courses, and fulfilled any other admission conditions including the English language requirement.
  - Fulfilment of any other admission requirements.
  - Students must use the thesis writing template prepared by the College of Graduate Studies.
- Three credit hours are assigned in the semester the thesis proposal is approved, with the remaining thesis credit hours registered in subsequent semesters.

Q: When during the semester can a student submit and register their thesis proposal?

Thesis Proposal Registration

Thesis proposal registration follows these steps:

- ❑ Students are eligible for thesis defense one semester after thesis proposal approval.
- ❑ Students must continue re-registering the thesis for zero credit hours every semester until the defense is completed.

Q: Can a student defend their thesis if they are registered for a course along with the thesis?

Thesis Defense

- Students may defend their thesis at least one semester after proposal approval, upon meeting the following conditions:
  - ✓ Minimum CGPA of 3.0 out of 4.0
  - ✓ Successful completion of all compulsory and elective courses
  - ✓ ORCID registration
  - ✓ Portfolio (U221*** and onwards) Submission
  - ✓ Publication of a research paper in a peer-reviewed academic journal (or conference), provided that the student is the primary author and the supervisor is a co-author.

Q: how to choose the conference or the journal?

Portfolio Circular

Based on the Graduate Studies Council decision No. (5) in its Meeting No. (5) Which was held on 24/03/2022 with regards to the subject above. The Council decided the following:

- All master students must submit a portfolio as a requirement for forming a thesis defense committee. The portfolio should include proof of achieving a specific number of points through participating in academic activities, such as attending thesis defense sessions – one point for each session, participating in workshops – one point for each session, and participating in conferences, seminars, and academic forums – one point for each session.
- All Ph.D. students must submit a portfolio as a requirement for forming a dissertation defense committee. The portfolio should include proof of achieving a specific number of points through participating in academic activities, such as attending thesis defense sessions – one point for each session, participating in workshops – one point for each session,

استنادا إلى قرار مجلس الدراسات العليا رقم (خامساً) في اجتماعه الخامس الذي انعقد بتاريخ 24-03-2022 حول الموضوع المشار إليه أعلاه، قرر المجلس ما يلي:

- يجب على كل طالب ماجستير تقديم حقيبة علمية (Portfolio) كمتطلب لتشكيل لجنة الدفاع عن الأطروحة، بحيث تحتوي هذه الحقيبة على وثائق تبين تحقيق عدد محدد من نقاط الأنشطة العلمية مثل حضور جلسات مناقشة الرسائل العلمية 1 نقطة واحدة لكل جلسة، المشاركة في ورش العمل 1 نقطة واحدة لكل جلسة، المشاركة في المؤتمرات والندوات والمنتديات العلمية 1 نقطة واحدة لكل جلسة.
- يجب على كل طالب الدكتوراه تقديم حقيبة علمية (Portfolio) كمتطلب لتشكيل لجنة الدفاع عن الأطروحة، بحيث تحتوي هذه الحقيبة على وثائق تبين تحقيق عدد محدد من نقاط الأنشطة العلمية مثل حضور جلسات مناقشة الرسائل العلمية 1 نقطة واحدة لكل جلسة، المشاركة في ورش العمل 1 نقطة واحدة لكل جلسة، المشاركة في المؤتمرات والندوات والمنتديات العلمية 1 نقطة واحدة لكل جلسة.
- يجب أن يتم التصديق على شهادة الحضور لجلسات مناقشة الرسائل من قبل منسق جلسات مناقشة الرسائل الجامعية.

Thesis Defense Results

- The committee will make one of the following decisions:
  - **Pass with minor modifications** (The committee gives the student a period not exceeding three months to make the necessary changes based on the Committee’s report).
  - **No pass for thesis.**
- No pass for thesis: the oral defense is satisfactory, but the thesis does not meet the academic criteria for awarding the master's degree. The student can submit a revised version of the thesis within six months.
- No pass for oral defense: The thesis is satisfactory, but the oral defense does not meet the academic criteria for awarding the master's degree. If this is the student's first "No Pass" result, they may re-defend their thesis within three to six months without submitting a revised thesis.

Thesis Defense Results

- No pass for oral defense and thesis: Both the thesis and the oral defense do not meet the academic criteria for awarding the master's degree. If this is the student's first "No Pass" result, they may submit a revised thesis within three to six months.

- **Students who receive a second "No Pass" decision will be withdrawn from the program, regardless of whether the previous "No Pass" was for the preliminary thesis or oral defense**.

Q: Do all students who successfully defend their thesis in the fall semester graduate in that same semester?

Graduate Studies

GS Webpage:

https://www.sharjah.ac.ae/en/Academics/Graduate-Studies

1. Project Funding (AED 15,000)
2. Conference Funding
3. Academic Calendar
4. Graduate Studies Academic Unit
5. Graduate Studies Workshops

Thank You